individuals." *Ibid.*; see *FCC* v. *AT&T Inc.*, 562 U. S. 397, 404–405 (2011) ("We have no doubt that 'person,' in a legal setting, often refers to artificial entities. The Dictionary Act makes that clear"). Thus, unless there is something about the RFRA context that "indicates otherwise," the Dictionary Act provides a quick, clear, and affirmative answer to the question whether the companies involved in these cases may be heard.

We see nothing in RFRA that suggests a congressional intent to depart from the Dictionary Act definition, and HHS makes little effort to argue otherwise. We have entertained RFRA and free-exercise claims brought by nonprofit corporations, see *Gonzales* v. *O Centro Espírita Beneficente União do Vegetal*, 546 U. S. 418 (2006) (RFRA); *Hosanna-Tabor Evangelical Lutheran Church and School* v. *EEOC*, 565 U. S. 171 (2012) (Free Exercise); *Church of Lukumi Babalu Aye, Inc.* v. *Hialeah*, 508 U. S. 520 (1993) (Free Exercise), and HHS concedes that a nonprofit corporation can be a "person" within the meaning of RFRA. See Brief for HHS in No. 13–354, at 17; Reply Brief in No. 13–354, pp. 7–8.[19]

This concession effectively dispatches any argument that the term "person" as used in RFRA does not reach the closely held corporations involved in these cases. No known understanding of the term "person" includes *some* but not all corporations. The term "person" sometimes encompasses artificial persons (as the Dictionary Act instructs), and it sometimes is limited to natural persons. But no conceivable definition of the term includes natural persons and nonprofit corporations, but not for-profit corporations.[20] Cf.

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[19] Cf. Brief for Federal Petitioners in *O Centro*, O. T. 2004, No. 04–1084, p. II (stating that the organizational respondent was "a New Mexico Corporation"); Brief for Federal Respondent in *Hosanna-Tabor*, O. T. 2011, No. 10–553, p. 3 (stating that the petitioner was an "ecclesiastical corporation").

[20] Not only does the Government concede that the term "persons" in RFRA includes nonprofit corporations, it goes further and appears to concede that the term might also encompass other artificial entities, namely,